ANALYTICAL REPORT

Seattle Airbnb Market Report

This report looks at how Seattle's Airbnb market performed in 2016, covering pricing, location trends, and revenue patterns.

Based on 3,818 active listings, over 1 million calendar records, and 84,000+ guest reviews.

1. At a Glance

3,818 Total Listings	**$128** Avg. Nightly Rate	**33%** Occupancy Rate	**$98M+** Est. Annual Revenue

94.5 Avg. Review Score (/100)	**20%** Superhosts	**1,811** 1-Bedroom Listings	**17** Neighborhoods

2. Pricing by Bedrooms

The more bedrooms a listing has, the higher the nightly rate. Here is how prices and supply break down across property sizes.

Bedrooms	Avg. Nightly Price	No. of Listings
1 Bedroom	$96	1,811
2 Bedrooms	$175	483
3 Bedrooms	$250	206
4 Bedrooms	$315	69
5 Bedrooms	$450	24
6 Bedrooms	$585	6

- 1-bedroom listings make up 63% of all supply. The market is built mostly for solo travelers and couples, which is why this segment is so crowded.
- The jump from 1 to 2 bedrooms nearly doubles the nightly price ($96 to $175). For small groups or families, a 2-bedroom listing offers much better value than booking two separate 1-bedroom units.
- There are only 6 listings with 6 bedrooms in the entire city. That scarcity alone pushes rates to $585 per night. Hosts with large properties face almost no competition.

- Properties with 4 or more bedrooms make up less than 3% of total supply. Given the pricing premium they command, this is an underserved part of the market where demand likely outpaces availability.

3. Pricing by Location

Where a listing is located has a major impact on what it can charge. Proximity to the city centre, waterfronts, and transit links pushes prices well above the market average.

ZIP Code	Area	Avg. Price	vs. Market Avg.
98134	SoDo	$207	+62%
98199	Magnolia	$172	+34%
98101	Downtown Core	$167	+30%
98119	Queen Anne	$166	+30%
98109	Lower Queen Anne	$150	+17%
98103	Fremont / Wallingford	$124	-3%
98115	Northeast Seattle	$115	-10%
98125	Lake City	$58	-55%

- SoDo (98134) tops the list at $207 per night despite not being a typical tourist spot. Its proximity to T-Mobile Park and Climate Pledge Arena creates concentrated demand on event nights, allowing hosts to charge a significant premium.
- Magnolia and Queen Anne are priced 30 to 34% above average. Both neighbourhoods offer water views, a walkable feel, and easy access to Seattle Center. Guests are willing to pay more for the neighbourhood experience itself, not just the room.
- Downtown (98101) benefits from a steady flow of business travelers and conference attendees. These guests are less price-sensitive and tend to book based on proximity to work commitments rather than cost.
- Lake City (98125) sits 55% below market average. It has limited transit access, is far from major attractions, and does not benefit from any strong demand driver. It serves a budget-focused segment of travelers.

4. Revenue Through the Year

Revenue nearly doubled over the course of 2016, growing from around $1.2M per week in January to over $2M per week by December. The growth was not uniform, and each phase of the year had a clear reason behind it.

Period	Est. Monthly Revenue	What Drove It

Jan to Feb	$6.1M to $7.0M	Post-holiday slowdown, fewer travelers booking
Mar to Apr	$8.3M to $7.9M	Spring conferences and tourism, brief April dip
May to Aug	$8.6M to $8.8M	Peak summer season, near-full occupancy
Sep to Nov	$8.4M to $8.6M	Stable fall demand, continued corporate travel
December	$9.1M	Holiday travel surge, highest month of the year

- January is the weakest month at $6.1M. After the holiday season ends, travel demand drops sharply. Guests have already used their year-end leave, and the next wave of bookings does not pick up until spring.
- March jumps to $8.3M because of spring break travel, early-year tech conferences, and improving weather that brings leisure visitors back to the city.
- The April dip to $7.9M is a predictable seasonal pattern. Spring break ends, schools resume, and corporate travel slows before the summer cycle begins. It is a brief pause, not a structural decline.
- Revenue plateaus through summer between $8.6M and $8.8M rather than continuing to rise. This is not because demand weakened. It is because the market was already running at near-full capacity. There were simply not enough available listings to absorb more guests, so revenue stopped climbing even as demand stayed high.
- December reaches $9.1M, the highest point of the year. Holiday travel, family visits, and year-end tourism all converge. Hosts also tend to raise rates during this window because they know guests will pay more around fixed holiday dates.

5. What the Market is Made Of

Two thirds of listings offer an entire home or apartment. Guests in Seattle strongly prefer private accommodation, and hosts respond to that by listing full properties rather than individual rooms.

Listing Type	**No. of Listings**	**Share of Market**
Entire Home or Apartment	2,541	66.6%
Private Room	1,160	30.4%
Shared Room	117	3.1%

Property Style	**No. of Listings**	**Share**
House	1,733	45.4%
Apartment	1,708	44.7%
Townhouse, Condo, and Other	377	9.9%

Houses and apartments are almost equally split, which reflects Seattle's broader housing mix. Shared rooms account for just 3.1% of listings, suggesting that guests here expect at minimum a private space to themselves.

6. Key Takeaways

- The market grew strongly through 2016. Revenue nearly doubled, driven by rising listings, strong summer demand, and a December holiday surge.
- Location is the most important pricing factor. Being near the city centre or the waterfront adds 30 to 60% to the nightly rate. Hosts in peripheral areas need to compete on price, reviews, and amenities.
- The 1-bedroom segment is oversupplied. With 63% of listings in this category, competition is high and pricing power is limited. Larger properties earn more per night with far fewer competitors.
- A 33% occupancy rate means that two thirds of available nights go unbooked. There is room for hosts to grow their earnings through better pricing strategy, more competitive listings, and improved visibility on the platform.
- Revenue plateauing in summer points to a supply problem, not weak demand. The market could support more listings in high-demand neighbourhoods without reducing existing hosts' occupancy rates.
- Guest satisfaction is strong at 94.5 out of 100. Hosts who maintain high standards have a clear path to Superhost status, which brings greater visibility and, over time, higher booking rates.

End of Report